

RECRUITMENT PROCESS REVIEW

THE PROCESS ISN'T SLOW. THE PROBLEM IS THE ENTRANCE.

One year of recruitment data shows the interview process works. The real opportunity is earlier: in who applies, and how the first screen handles them.

PRESENTED BY DENERSON • JUL 2026

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SOURCING CHANNELS

WHERE HIRES COME FROM, AND WHERE THEY DON'T

The most efficient channel is the least used, while three channels cost screening effort and return no hires.

HIRES BY CHANNEL

LinkedIn



233 hires · 33% conversion

Employee Referral



54 hires · 89% conversion

Careers Site



8 hires · 5% conversion

Agency, Indeed and University Job Board are not shown: they produced zero hires.

WE KNOW WHO APPLIES. BUT MOST NEVER GET PAST THE FIRST SCREEN.

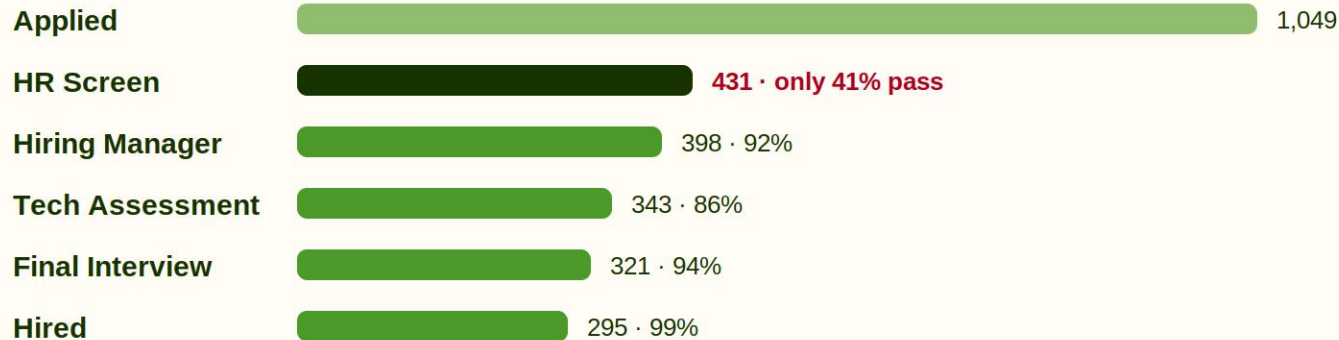
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FUNNEL HEALTH

THE BOTTLENECK IS THE FIRST SCREEN, NOT THE INTERVIEW STAGES

82% of all funnel losses happen at the first screen. Everyone past it moves smoothly to hire.

CANDIDATES BY STAGE



Every stage after HR Screen converts above 86%.

A BLIND SPOT

55%

of candidates have no recorded exit stage.

Half the funnel's exits are invisible, so the real drop-off points are uncertain.

THE ENTRANCE LEAKS. IS THE PROCESS AFTER IT SLOW TOO?

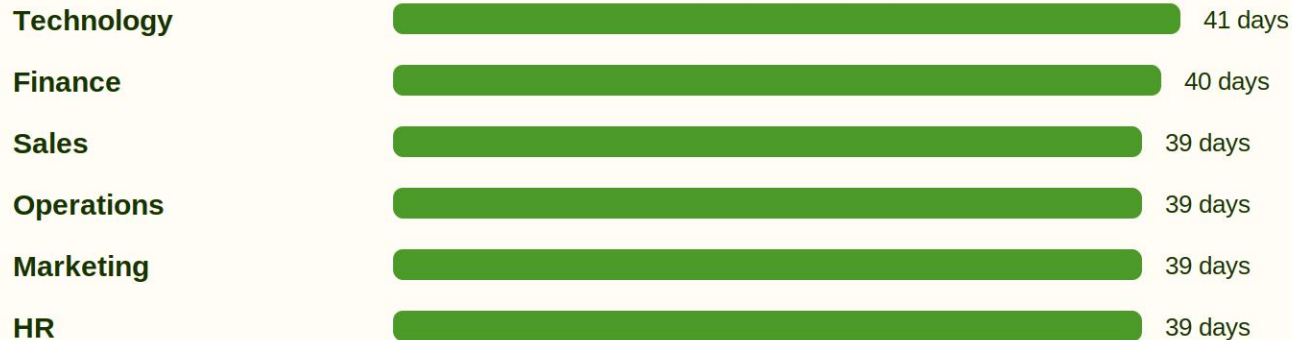
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TIME TO HIRE

ONCE PAST THE SCREEN, HIRING IS FAST AND EVEN ACROSS TEAMS

About 40 days in every department. The process itself is not the delay.

MEDIAN TIME TO HIRE, BY DEPARTMENT



Only a 2-day spread between the fastest and slowest team.

A DATA CAVEAT

412 days

is the official time to fill.

The dates behind it don't add up, so time to hire is the measure we trust.

SPEED ISN'T THE PROBLEM. THE FIX IS THE ENTRANCE.

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RECOMMENDATIONS

WHERE TO ACT FIRST

Interviews aren't the problem. Each move sharpens the entry into the funnel.

1

Reallocate sourcing effort

Three channels take 121 applications for zero hires. Move that effort into referrals, which convert 2.7x better.

QUICK WIN

2

Fix the first-screen blind spot

82% of losses happen here, yet 55% of exits are unrecorded. Audit the screen and start logging exit stages.

INVESTIGATE

3

Track a metric you can trust

Time to fill is distorted by bad dates. Adopt time to hire, and investigate the long gap before applications arrive.

FOUNDATIONAL

The gains aren't in going faster. They're in better entry, sharper screening,
and a funnel the team can actually see.

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